

EXP 8

Configuring User Management and Role-Based Access Control (RBAC) in a Zoho Creator Application Vehicle Service Request Form

1. AIM

To configure user management and role-based access control (RBAC) for the "Vehicle Service Request Form" application in Zoho Creator, so that every category of user — Admin, Manager, Lead, and portal-based customers — is assigned an appropriately scoped role and permission profile, record visibility follows the reporting hierarchy, and the application interface is localized correctly for each user, without granting any user access beyond what their role requires.

2. PROCEDURE

2.1 Defining Roles and the Role Hierarchy

1. Open the application in Zoho Creator and go to Settings > Permissions > User Permissions > Roles tab. Select the "lead" role, set "Reports to" as CEO, and add the description "checks the service forms and updates it".
2. Set "Share Data with Peers" to Yes so that users placed under the same role can view each other's service request records. The users assigned to this role are listed under Associated Users.

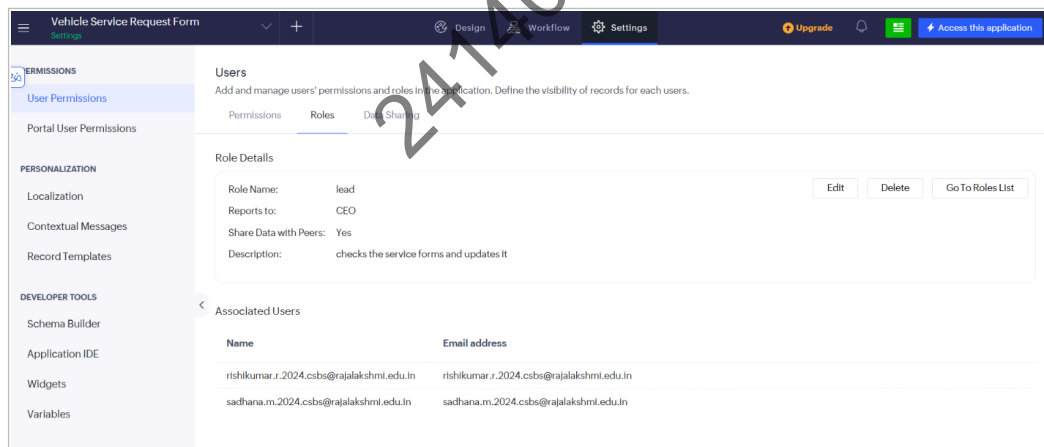


Fig 2.1: Roles tab — lead role configured with reporting hierarchy

Explanation: The "Reports to" field builds the reporting chain (lead to CEO) that Zoho Creator uses to decide which records a role can see above its own. "Share Data with Peers" extends visibility sideways to others holding the same role, so both leads can see and update the same service forms. Together these settings define the vertical and horizontal reach of the lead role's access, and the Associated Users table shows exactly who holds the role.

2.2 Creating Permission Profiles for Each User Category

3. Go to Settings > Permissions > User Permissions > Permissions tab and click "Add Permission" to create a separate permission profile for each category of user — admin and manager — each with its own descriptive name, alongside the built-in Read and Write profiles.

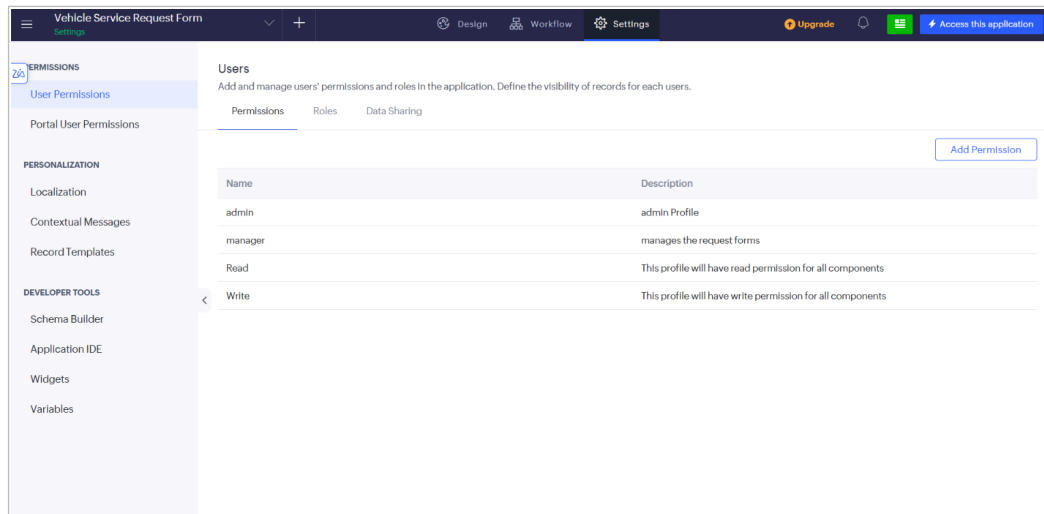


Fig 2.2: Permissions tab listing the permission profiles available in the application

Explanation: Each permission profile is an independently editable set of module-level and field-level access rights. The "admin" profile is meant for administration, the "manager" profile manages the request forms, while Read gives read-only access and Write gives write access to all components. Using named profiles instead of one shared profile ensures each user can act only on the forms and reports relevant to their function, which is the core of role-based access control.

2.3 Setting Portal User Permissions

4. Go to the "Portal User Permissions" tab to manage access for portal users — customers who interact with the application from outside the core organisation. Here the "Customer", "manager_permissions", and "user_permission" profiles are available as portal-level permissions.

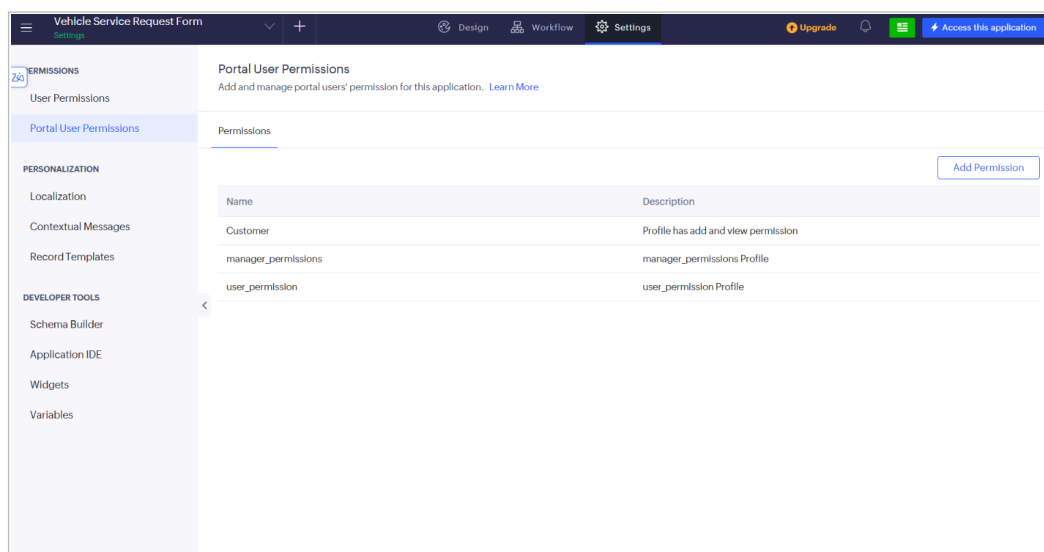


Fig 2.3: Portal User Permissions tab showing the profiles available to portal users

Explanation: Portal users are kept separate from internal application users so that customer-facing accounts can be given a restricted set of permissions without exposing internal roles or developer settings. The "Customer" profile has add and view permission only, which lets a customer submit a vehicle service request and view it, but not change or delete other records.

2.4 Configuring Application Localization

5. Go to Settings > Personalization > Localization and choose which language the application should use. "User's browser language" is selected, with English kept as the default language and German added as an additional language.

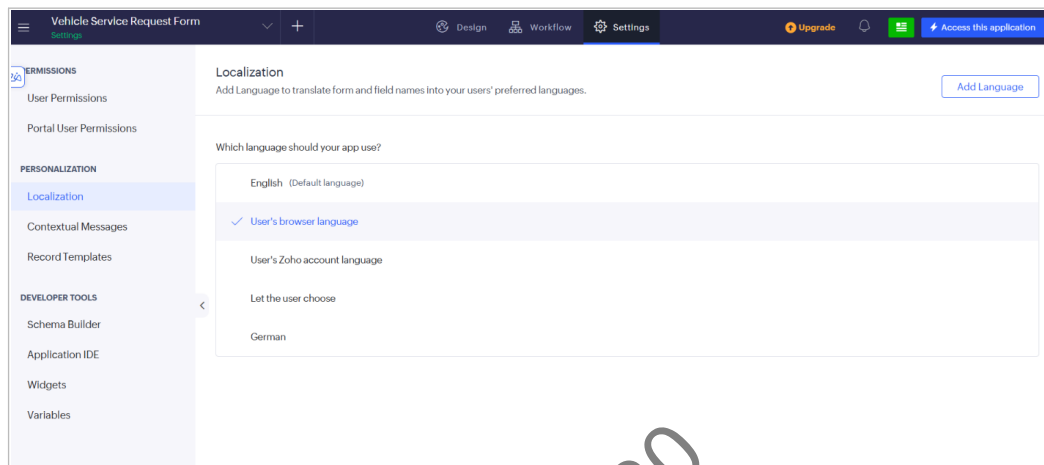


Fig 2.4: Localization settings for the application

Explanation: Localization works alongside RBAC to make the application usable for every user. Once a user's permission profile decides what they can access, the localization setting decides the language in which form and field names are displayed—based on their browser, their Zoho account language, or a language they choose themselves.

2.5 Verifying Workflow Automations Under the Configured Roles

6. Go to the Workflow tab > Form workflows and confirm that the workflows built for the "Repair Request Management" form remain Enabled—the validations workflow on form submission (3 actions) and the successful form submission workflow (1 action).

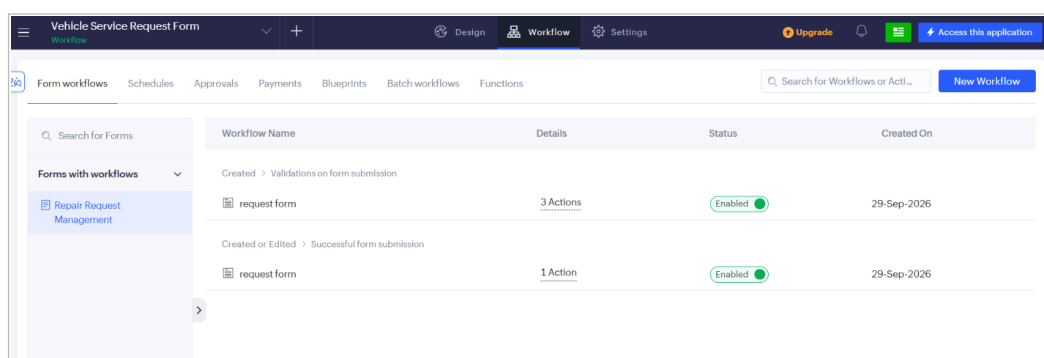


Fig 2.5: Form workflows list showing the request form workflows still enabled

Explanation: The validation workflow runs when a record is created, and the successful form submission workflow runs when a record is created or edited. They fire regardless of which authorised role submits or edits the request form. Because these automations sit beneath the permission and role layer, they continue to execute consistently, confirming that RBAC and workflow automation operate

together without conflict.

2.6 Adding a User and Assigning a Role and Permission

7. Open the Zoho Creator home page and go to Users > Add User. Enter the user's email address and name, keep "Send Notification Mail" ticked, and under Add to Application > Applications as User select the "Vehicle Service Request Form" application, set the Role to "lead" and the Permission to "Write", then click Add User. Repeat the same steps for the second user.

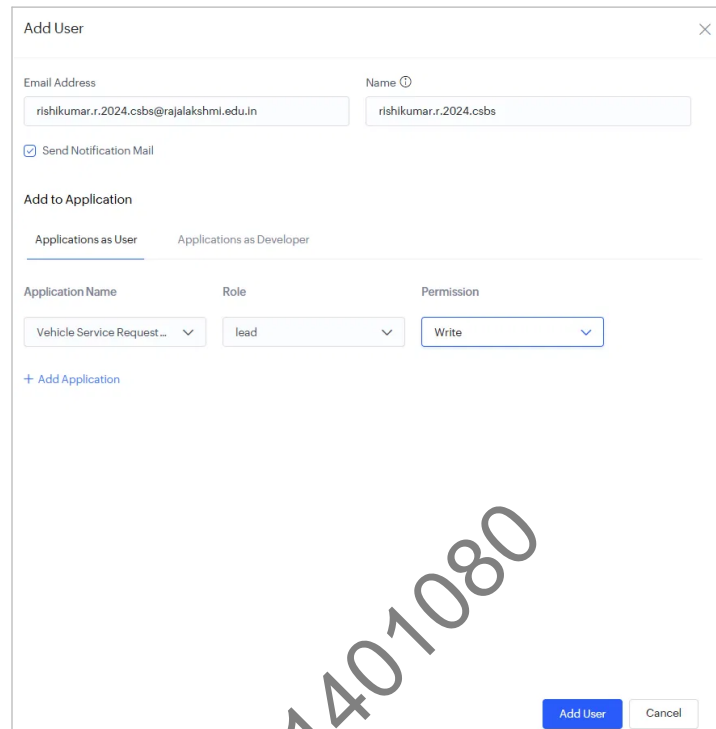


Fig 2.6: Add User dialog — user added to the application with the lead role and Write permission

Explanation: Creating the user is what ties the role and permission profiles defined earlier to a real person. Selecting the lead role places the user in the reporting hierarchy, and the Write permission decides which components the user can add or edit, so the user receives only the access that role requires. The notification mail invites the user to access the application.

3. OUTPUT

Once the roles, permission profiles, portal permissions and localization settings were saved and the users were added, the All Users page listed the users who now have access to the application.

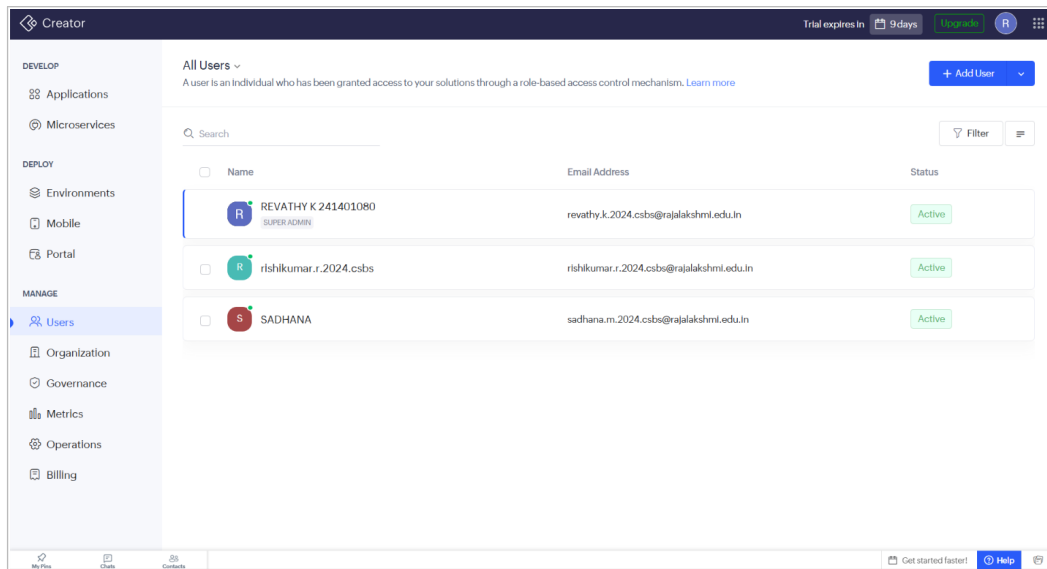


Fig 3: All Users page in Zoho Creator showing the users added to the application

Explanation: The All Users page confirms that the two newly added users (rishikumar.r.2024.csbs and SADHANA) appear alongside the Super Admin account, and that every listed user has the status Active. This shows the role and permission assignment was saved successfully and that these users can now sign in and work in the application within the access granted to their role.

4. RESULT

Role-based access control was successfully configured for the "Vehicle Service Request Form" application in Zoho Creator. Distinct roles and permission profiles were created for each category of user, a reporting hierarchy was established for the lead role with peer data sharing, portal users were restricted to a limited set of permission profiles, and the application interface was localized to the user's browser language. This ensures every user interacts only with the data and features appropriate to their role, while workflow automations continue to run correctly underneath the configured access layer. Users were also added to the application with the lead role and Write permission, and they are listed as Active.